Establishment (ADE). The motor had been type- approved by DTD&P (Air). This was a smal but significant step towards developing missile hardware that is not only functional but also acceptable to the user agencies. A private sector firm was engaged to produce a reliable, airworthy, high thrust-to-weight ratio rocket motor with technology input from DRDL. We were slowly graduating from single laboratory projects to multi-laboratory programmes to laboratory-industry exercises. The development of PTA symbolized a great confluence of four different organizations. I felt as if I was standing at a meeting point and looking at the roads coming from ADE, DTD&P (Air) and ISRO. The fourth road was the DRDL, a highway to national self-reliance in missile technology. Taking our partnership with the academic institutions of the country a step further, Joint Advanced Technology Programmes were started at the Indian Institute of Science (I Sc), and Jadavpur University. I have always had a deep